Personal Expense Tracker – Project Write-Up

🔹 Introduction

In today's fast-paced lifestyle, managing personal finances is essential to avoid overspending and ensure financial stability. This project, **Personal Expense Tracker**, is a simple yet effective application designed to help users record, categorize, and monitor their daily expenses. It provides insights into spending patterns and helps users stay within their monthly budget.

🔹 Objective

The main objectives of this project are:

- To develop a system for recording daily expenses
- To categorize expenses for better financial analysis
- To allow users to set and track a monthly budget
- To implement file handling for saving and retrieving expense data
- To create a user-friendly, menu-driven interface

🔹 Features

The application includes the following key features:

1. **Add Expense**
   Users can input details such as date, category, amount, and description. Each expense is stored as a structured record.
2. **View Expenses**
   Displays all recorded expenses in a readable format, ensuring incomplete data is handled appropriately.
3. **Budget Management**
   Users can set a monthly budget and track their total spending. The system alerts users if they exceed their budget or shows the remaining balance.
4. **File Handling (CSV)**
   - Expenses are saved in a CSV file for persistence
   - Data is automatically loaded when the program starts
5. **Menu-Driven Interface**
   A simple interactive menu allows users to navigate through different functionalities easily.

🔹 Technologies Used

- **Programming Language:** Python
- **Libraries:**

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- csv for file handling
- os for file operations

Working of the System

- The program starts by loading previously saved expenses from a CSV file.
- Users interact with the system through a menu.
- Based on the user's choice, the program performs actions like adding expenses, viewing records, or tracking the budget.
- Before exiting, the system saves all data to ensure no information is lost.

Conclusion

The Personal Expense Tracker is a practical tool that demonstrates the use of Python for real-world problem-solving. It effectively combines data structures, file handling, and user interaction to create a useful financial management application. This project can be further enhanced with features like data visualization, category-wise analysis, or a graphical user interface.